

ways to use the word *why*. When he turned 12, he became eligible to mow our lawn. The first thing he asked was, "How much?" I said, "I'll pay you \$7." He replied, "It's not worth it. I'm not going to mow that lawn for \$7." I said, "That's OK, but that's the only way you have to earn money. If you don't do it, you don't get any money, you understand that." He said, "Sure, Dad. But I'm not going to mow that lawn for \$7."

So I went to a friend who had a son about the same age, and negotiated with him to mow the lawn for \$7. He was there within five minutes, mowing my lawn. Every week after that, my son mowed our lawn. He decided, if it was worth it to his friend, it was worth it to him.

BE FAIR, BUT FIRM

You need to be fair with your children but also firm. There are some simple rules to observe. According to Matthew 10:10, "The worker is worthy of his support." I believe that's true with our children as well. If you want to train your children to be good employees, you must take on the role of an employer. Therefore, you have to establish some principles that any reasonable employer would.

(1) *Pay them only for jobs that are completed.* I told my children from the beginning, you don't get 90 percent of the money for 90 percent of the job. You get 100 percent of the money for 100 percent of the job. In other words, if you don't finish, you don't get paid. Why? Because no employer is going to pay them for a partially finished job. What if an employee decided, "I don't want to work five days a week, so I'll only work four days." Do you think an employer would agree? Hardly so; most employers expect a full week's work. It would be like a car painter saying, "I don't like painting a whole car. I'll just paint half of it, so just pay me for the half I paint." It just doesn't work that way. As Proverbs 12:11 says, "He who tills his land will have plenty of bread, but he who pursues vain things lacks sense."

(2) *Pay for quality work.* Scripture says, "Whatever you do, do your work heartily, as for the Lord rather than for men"